

Cyrus Gazdar, MA.

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Fields of Interest

International Relations, Conflict Studies, Liberal Internationalism, Mixed Methods, American Politics, Cold War History.

Education

- 2026-2027 **Simon Fraser University** | Burnaby, British Columbia.
M.A. in Political Science
Fields of Study: *Quantitative Methods & Mixed Methods, International Relations, Conflict Studies, Democratization.*
- 2022-2026 **University of Toronto** | Toronto, Ontario.
Honours Bachelor of Arts, With *High Distinction*. 3.50 CGPA.
Political Science (3.7 GPA), History (3.47 GPA).
Key Coursework: Research Methods in Political Science I & II (POL242 & 243); Data Visualization in the Social Sciences (POL342); Contemporary Challenges in International Relations (POL210); Oil, Energy, and Culture in American Society (HIS494); Understanding Military Power & Conflict (POL312 & 313); European Politics I & II (POL313 & 314); Insurgents, Criminals, and Warlords (POL406).

Research & Teaching Experience

Research Experience

- March- June 2026 **University of Toronto | Dr Geoffrey Dancy**
Project: *Transitional Justice Evaluation Tools* | [\[TJET Website\]](#)
- Contributed to a vast, open-source repository containing hundreds of cases of international human rights violations.
- Scraped through several repositories to find information about court cases and criminal prosecutions
- Utilized various Research & data visualization tools to filter & sort through hundreds of court cases.
- Sifted through over 100 names for further database review
- September 2025 - June 2026 **University of Toronto | Dr Alison Smith**
Project: *UTM Undergraduate Journal of Political Science*
- Worked in a small team of 5 to set up the first undergraduate political science journal at the University of Toronto Mississauga campus.
- Served as the editor for submissions in Book Reviews & Comparative Politics.
- Wrote 2 critical book reviews relevant to journal culture & policies
- Established guidelines & journal policies regarding citations & AI Policies.
- Ran presentations in several classes to promote the journal to over 100 students, & outreached to MA students & candidates to serve as peer reviewers.
- Made the website for the first issue, & authored a guidebook on how to continue the Journal for prospective editors.

Projects

- Comparative Democracy Index** Scraped data from major democracy indices to construct an open-source digital database of democracy scores with nearly 15,000 observations, spanning over 200 countries between 1940 and 2025. Additional variables, such as scaled scores and z-scores, are also included. [\[Volume 1\]](#)

Affiliations

Co-Founder; Reviewer & Editor, Comparative Politics & Book Reviews. *UTM Undergraduate Journal of Political Science*.

Conferences

"United we Stand, Divided we Drive: How Highways Served as Racial Mechanisms in 20th-Century American Life," **Presenter at the 2025 Prandium Conference**, Mississauga, April 7, 2025.

Academic Publications

"Freed Bondage: How American Liberalism and Slavery Collided in Early American Politics." *UTM Undergraduate Journal of Political Science* 1, no. 1 (2026): 1-9. (In Submission).

Initiatives

March 2, 2026. Helped plan and worked at **The Politics of Nonviolence: Traditions, Tensions, and Transformations** Conference at the University of Toronto Mississauga.

Awards and Honours

2026	Dean's List Scholar , University of Toronto Mississauga
2024	Sustainability Award (\$115) , University of Toronto Mississauga Student Union. Social Justice and Equity Award (\$115) , University of Toronto Mississauga Student Union. Charity Award (\$115) , University of Toronto Mississauga Student Union.
2022	Ontario Scholar , Government of Ontario.

Certifications

2026	Youth CAN Sustain Certificate , SDSN Canada, University of Calgary.
2025	Certificate Degree in Global Perspectives (3.68 GPA), University of Toronto Mississauga. UNICEF Youth Advocate Certification , UNICEF Canada.

Technical Skills

Languages	English (Native), French (Beginner)
Programming Languages	R, Python
Markup Languages & Developer Tools	LaTeX, html, VSCode, Excel, CSS, Quarto, Git, Airtable
Data Visualization Tools	VOS-Viewer, Gephi, Graphia, NodeXL

Academic References

Dr. Alexander Reisenbichler
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Dr. Noel Anderson
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